

MGT0114 - Entrepreneurship

Week 3: Types of Innovation, Idea Generation

Winter 2026

What does “Success” look like to you?



1

Go to wooclap.com

2

Enter the event code in the top banner

Event code
NDLURX



Plan for today

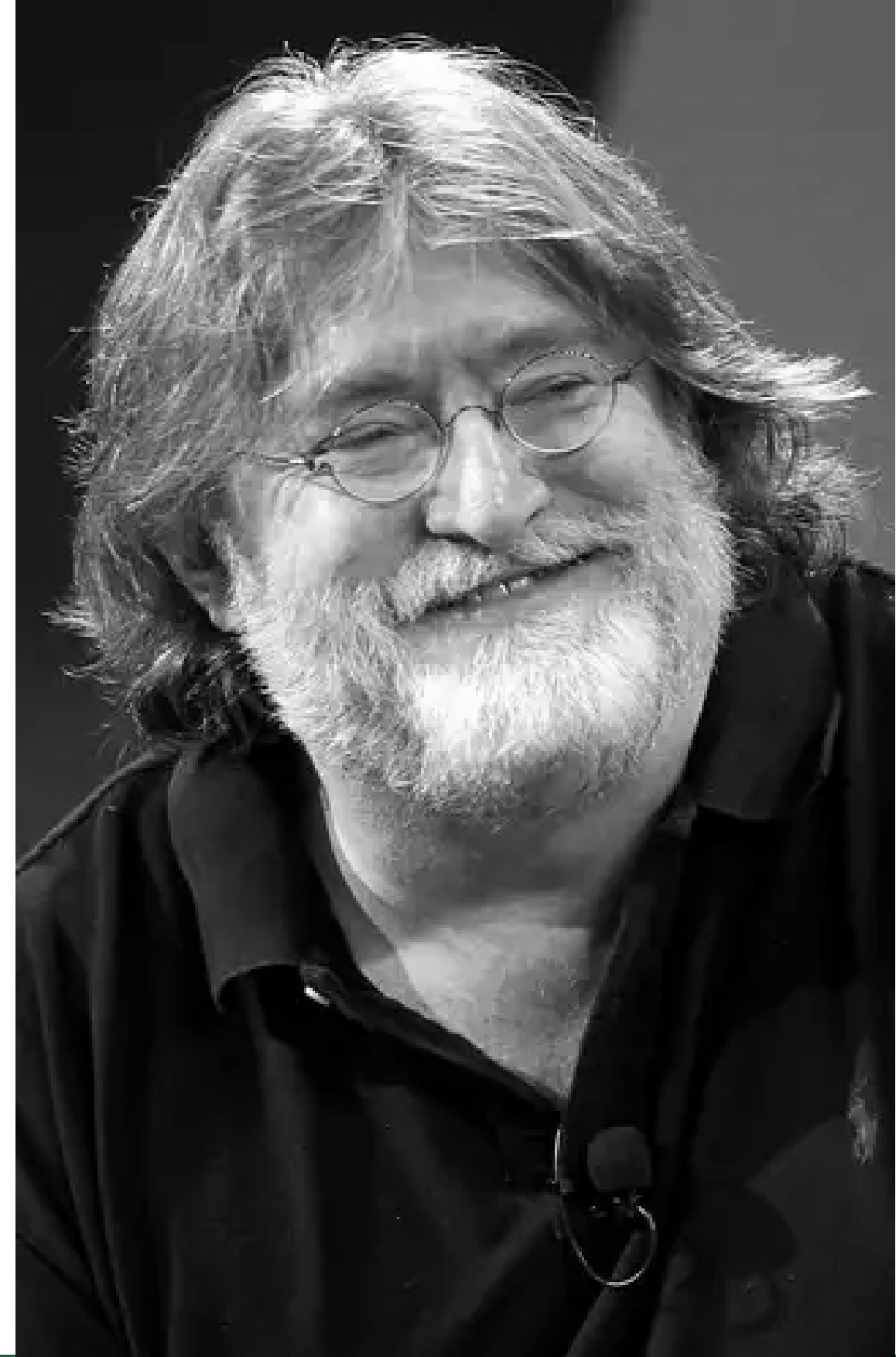
- **Albert Einstein:** Physicist, developed the theory of relativity, revolutionized our understanding of space, time, gravity, and the universe. Nobel Prize winner.
- **Bob Dylan:** Singer-songwriter, poet. One of the most influential musicians of the 20th century, tackled social justice and philosophical themes in his music.
- **Martin Luther King Jr.:** Civil rights leader, minister, champion of nonviolent resistance against racial segregation. Nobel Peace Prize winner.
- **Richard Branson:** Entrepreneur, founder of the Virgin Group, known for his adventurous spirit and various business ventures.
- **John Lennon (with Yoko Ono):** Musician, songwriter, peace activist. Co-founder of The Beatles, later explored solo career and activism with his wife Yoko Ono.
- **Buckminster Fuller:** Architect, futurist, inventor. Known for the geodesic dome design and his systems thinking approach.
- **Thomas Edison:** Inventor, businessman. Developed many devices including the lightbulb, phonograph, and motion picture camera.
- **Muhammad Ali:** Boxer, activist. Heavyweight champion, known for his skill, showmanship, and activism on civil rights.

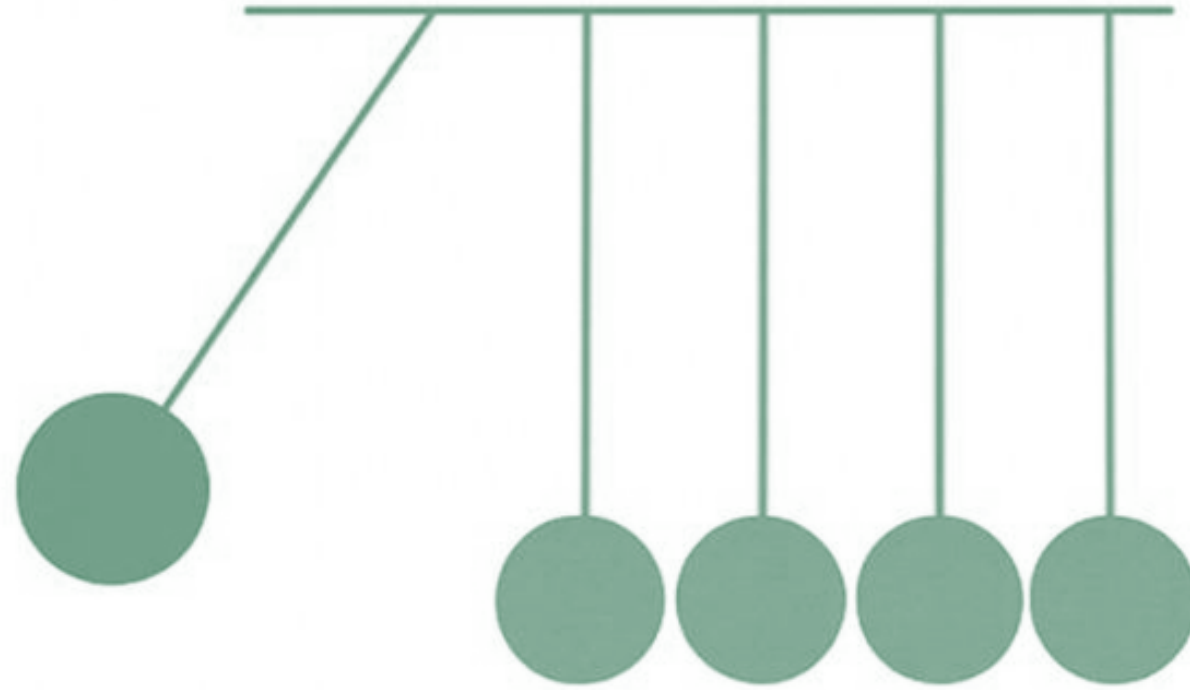
Plan for today

- **Mahatma Gandhi:** Leader of Indian independence movement against British rule. Espoused nonviolent civil disobedience.
- **Amelia Earhart:** Aviator. First female pilot to fly solo across the Atlantic Ocean.
- **Alfred Hitchcock:** Filmmaker. Master of suspense, pioneered many techniques in thrillers and psychological dramas.
- **Maria Callas:** Opera singer. One of the most renowned and influential opera singers of the 20th century.
- **Pablo Picasso:** Artist. Co-founder of Cubism, hugely influential on 20th century art with groundbreaking styles.
- **Jim Henson (with Kermit the Frog):** Puppeteer, filmmaker. Creator of The Muppets and iconic characters like Kermit, Miss Piggy, and Big Bird.
- **Frank Lloyd Wright:** Architect and designer. Pioneer of modern organic architecture, with a focus on harmony between structures and their environment.

Something to think about

"Piracy is almost always a service problem and not a pricing problem. For example, if a pirate offers a product purchasable from the convenience of your PC, and the legal provider says the product can only be purchased at a brick and mortar store, then the pirate's service is more valuable." - Gabe Newell, co-founder, Valve

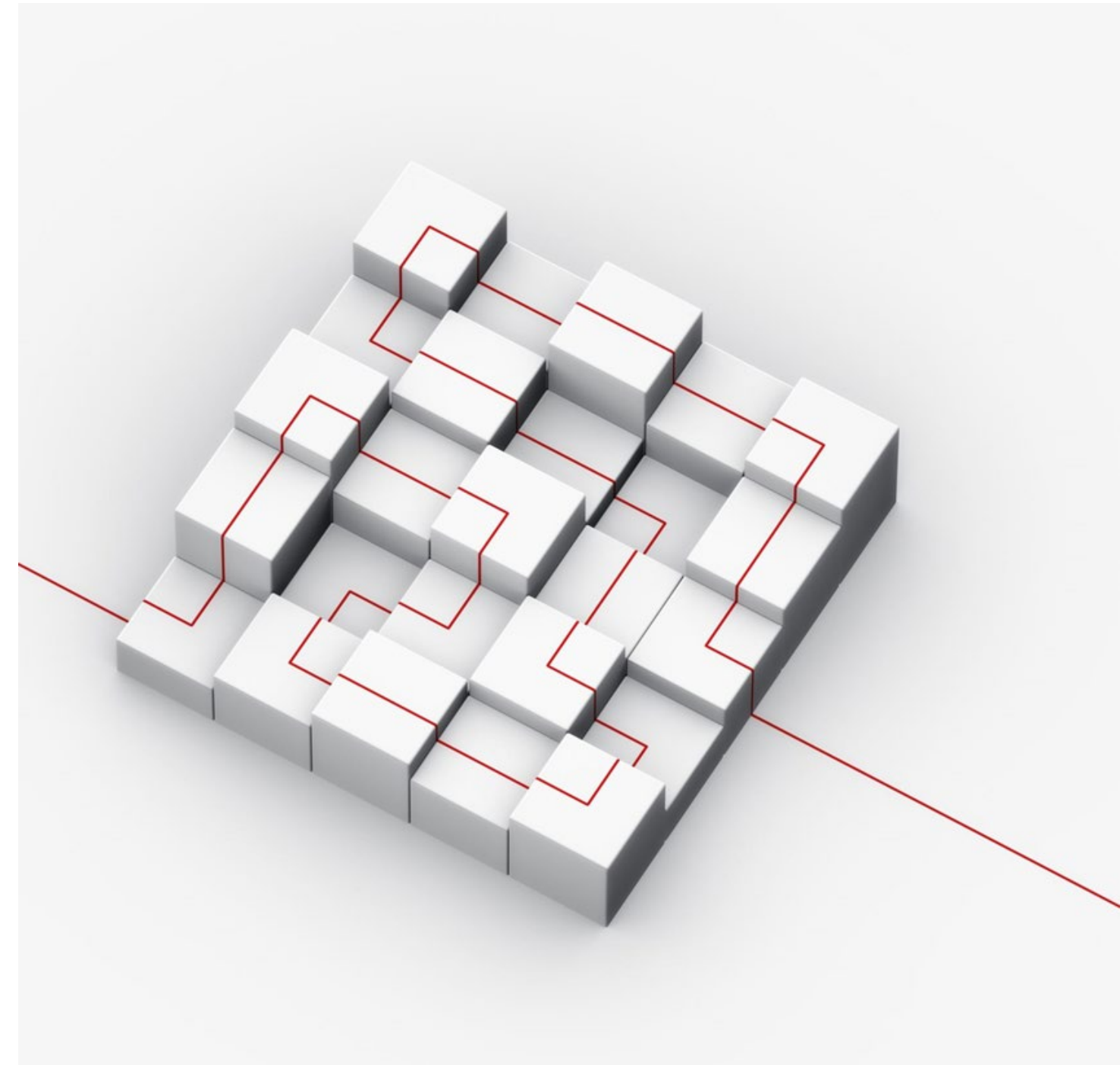




*the first step
is never just
a first step*

Plan for today

- **Schedule**
- **Assignment**
- **Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice**
 - **Types of Innovation**
 - **Idea Generation**
 - **Solution Generation**
 - **Lean Canvas Recap**



	Theme & Learning Outcomes	Assessments (%)
Week 1 Jan 14	Intro to Entrepreneurship and Innovation	Journal 5%
Week 2 Jan 21	Entrepreneurship, Emerging Tech, Economic Growth	Journal 5%
Week 3 Jan 28	Types of Innovation, Problems and Solutions	Assignment 5%
Week 4 Feb 4	Success Drivers in Tech Sector, Metrics	Quiz 5%
Week 5 Feb 11	Stakeholders in Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Early Adopters	Journal 5%
Week 6 Feb 18	Business Goals and Vision, Market Research and Marketing Strategies	Business/Project Idea 5%
Week 7 Feb 25	Midterm Exam	Midterm Exam 20%
Week 8	Study Break Week – NO CLASS	

	Theme & Learning Outcomes	Assessments (%)
Week 9 March 11	Business Planning, Revenues, Costs	Group Contract 5%
Week 10 March 18	Contract Negotiation	
Week 11 March 25	Budgeting and Finance in IT Projects	Business/Project Plan Part I 10%
Week 12 April 1	Leadership and Organization Design	EI Assignment 5%
Week 13 April 8	Developing a Technology-focused Business Plan	Business/Project Plan Part II 10% Demo and Plan Presentation 10%
Week 14 April 15	Business Plan Presentations and Wrap-up	Self, Peer Evaluations 10%
Week 15	Final Exam Week (NO EXAM)	

Assignment

Assignment

- Due: Sunday, midnight
- Use template on Brightspace assignment
- Replace **highlighted areas** with your answers
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Watch How to know if you were meant to be an Entrepreneur

Assignment – Week 03

Analysis of the Birth and Growth of a Tech Company

Objective

To analyze the early stages of a tech company, focusing on its entrepreneurial roots, initial innovations, and contributions to economic growth.

Purpose

1. Apply theoretical concepts about entrepreneurship, innovation, and economic growth to real-world examples.
2. Gain an understanding of the practical aspects of starting a technology company and the challenges faced in the early stages.
3. Understand the role of innovation in driving a startup's success and how different types of innovation contribute to a company's growth.
4. Evaluate the impact that technology startups can have on economic growth and technological advancements.

Slack Profile



slack

Early Days (2009-2012):

2009: Slack begins as internal tool at Tiny Speck, a game development company founded by Stewart Butterfield, during the creation of the game Glitch.

2010: Tiny Speck raises significant funding from venture capital firms Accel Partners and Andreessen Horowitz.

2011: Glitch is launched but **fails** to gain traction.

2012: Tiny Speck shuts down Glitch, but the team recognizes the potential of Slack as a standalone product.



Slack Profile



Slack's Launch and Growth (2013-2018):

2013: Launched in beta, 8,000 users in the first 24 hours.

2014: Widespread adoption. Known for user-friendly UI & efficient team communication

2015: Daily active users increase rapidly. Receives significant investments, valuing the company at billions of dollars.

2016-2017: Competition heats up. Facebook and Microsoft launch their own collaboration tools. Slack continues to expand its enterprise offerings and secure major clients like IBM and 21st Century Fox.

2018: Slack surpasses 8 million daily active users.

Slack Profile



Going Public and Acquisition (2019-2021):

2019: June: Slack goes public through a direct listing on the New York Stock Exchange, reaching a market valuation of nearly \$20 billion. Daily active users exceed 10 million.

2020: Salesforce announces its acquisition of Slack for a staggering \$27.7 billion.

Slack Success



- **Problem-Solving:** Slack identified the pain point of inefficient email communication and created a solution that resonates with businesses.
- **User Experience:** Prioritizing a clean, intuitive interface contributed to widespread adoption.
- **Growth Strategy:** Freemium model (free basic plan, paid upgrades) allowed users to try the platform and upgrade as their needs grew.
- **Adaptability:** Integrations and customizability make it versatile and relevant across different industries.
- **Acquisition:** Demonstrates the potential for successful startups to be acquired by larger companies.

Slack Success



- Slack's success story highlights the importance of recognizing opportunity even in the face of failure (pivoting from Glitch to Slack).
- User experience and effective communication crucial in driving Slack's rapid adoption.
- Slack's journey demonstrates dynamic nature of tech industry, with constant competition and the potential for large acquisitions.
- $\$27.7\text{B} \times 8.6\% = \2.4B

Something to think about

"You actually have to care about what you're doing. The business has to be **about something. Whatever the point of it is does not have to be inconsistent with making money, but usually if that's the sole reason, it is not very successful." - Stewart Butterfield, Founder, Slack**



Types of Innovation



Types of Innovation

1. Incremental Innovation
2. Radical Innovation
3. Disruptive Innovation
4. Architectural Innovation



Types of Innovation

- 5. Process Innovation
- 6. Product Innovation
- 7. Service Innovation
- 8. Business Model Innovation



Discussion

Think of a recent innovation. What type of innovation is/was it?

1. Incremental Innovation
2. Radical Innovation
3. Disruptive Innovation
4. Architectural Innovation
5. Process Innovation
6. Product Innovation
7. Service Innovation
8. Business Model Innovation

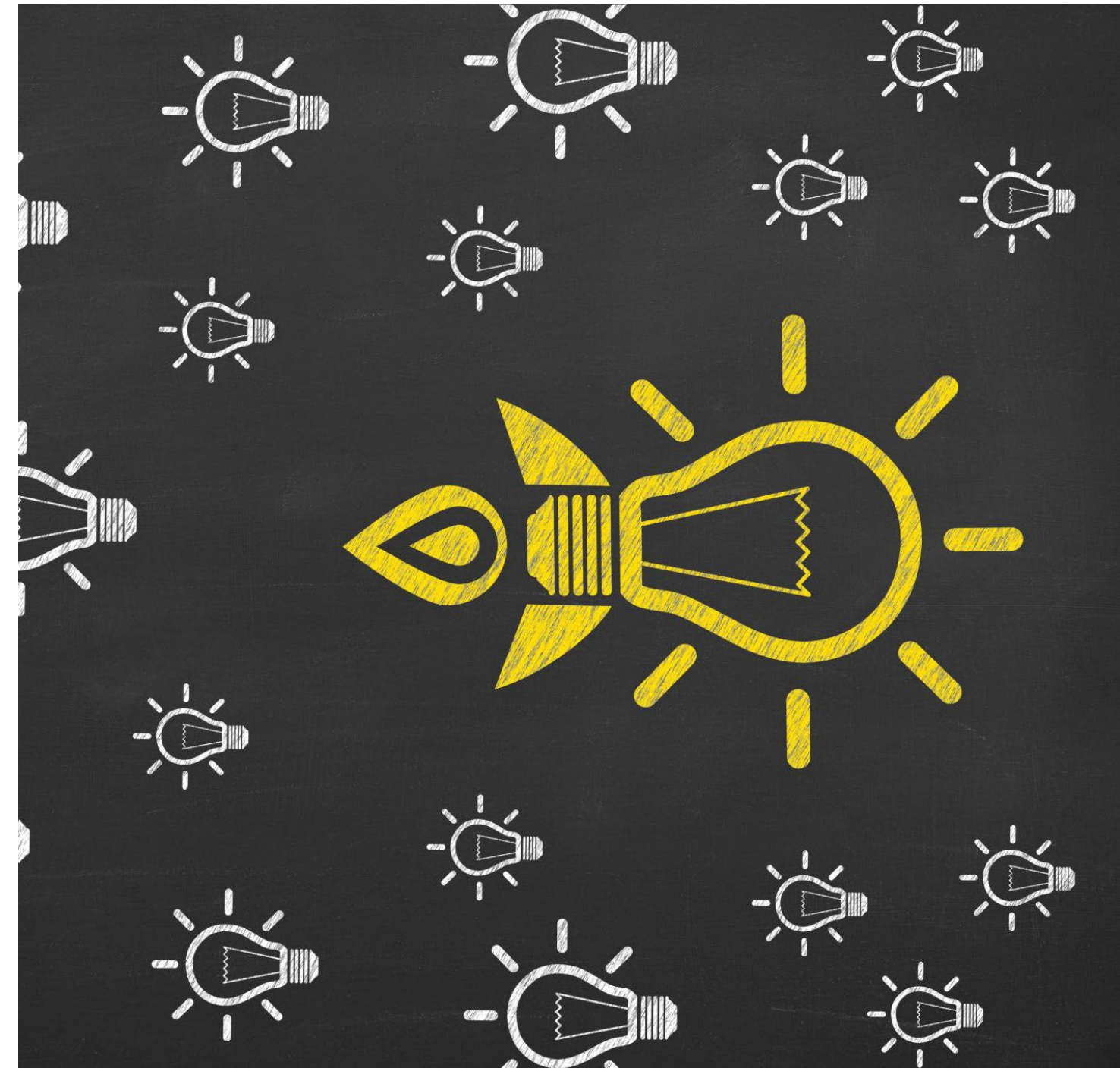


Idea Generation



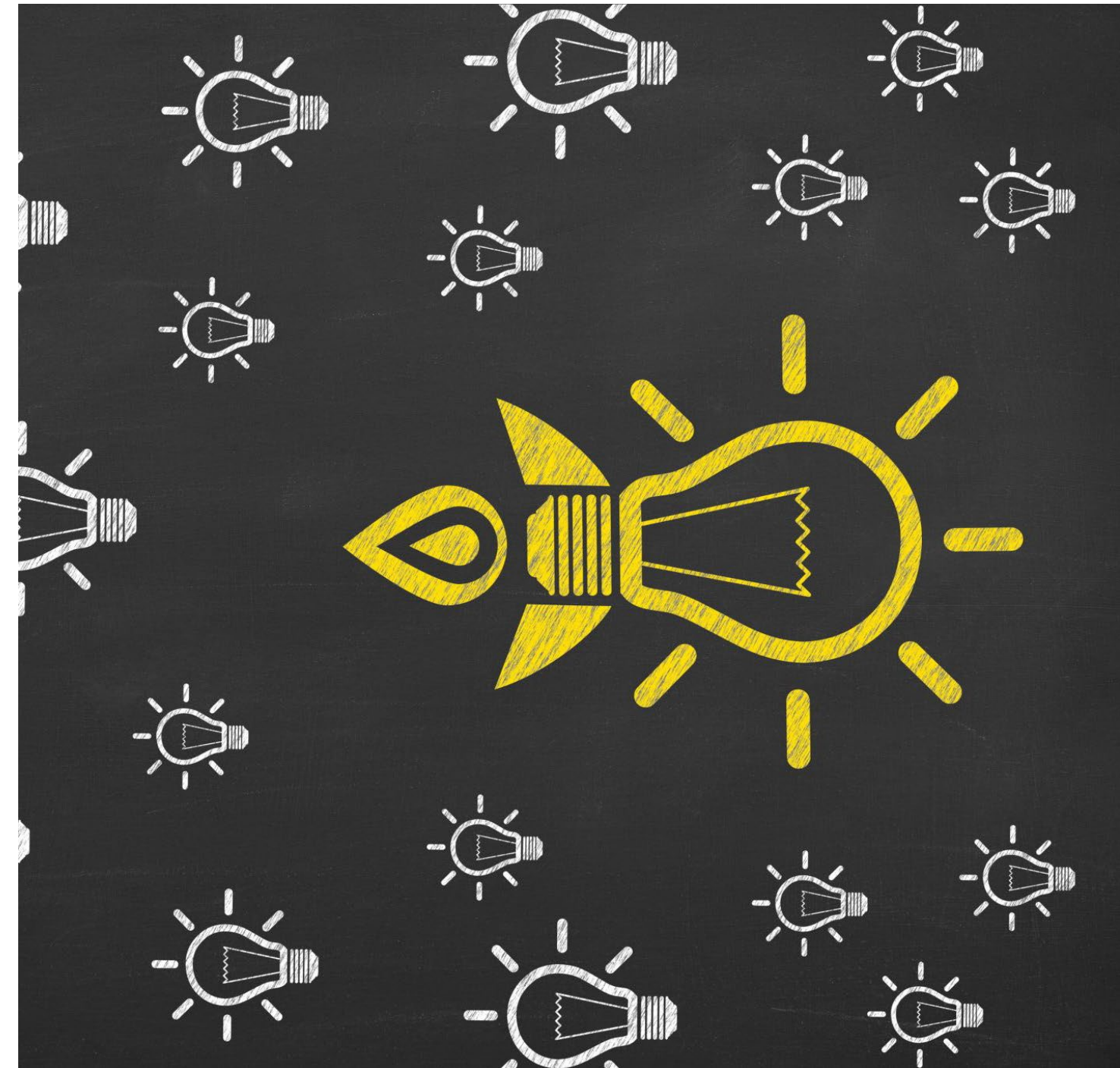
Idea Generation

1. Identify Your Passion
2. Find a Problem to Solve
3. Market Research
4. Brainstorm
5. Seek Inspiration from Others



Idea Generation

6. Network
7. Evaluate Existing Products and Services
8. Think About The Future
9. Prototype and Get Feedback
10. Keep an Ideas Journal
11. OTHERS?

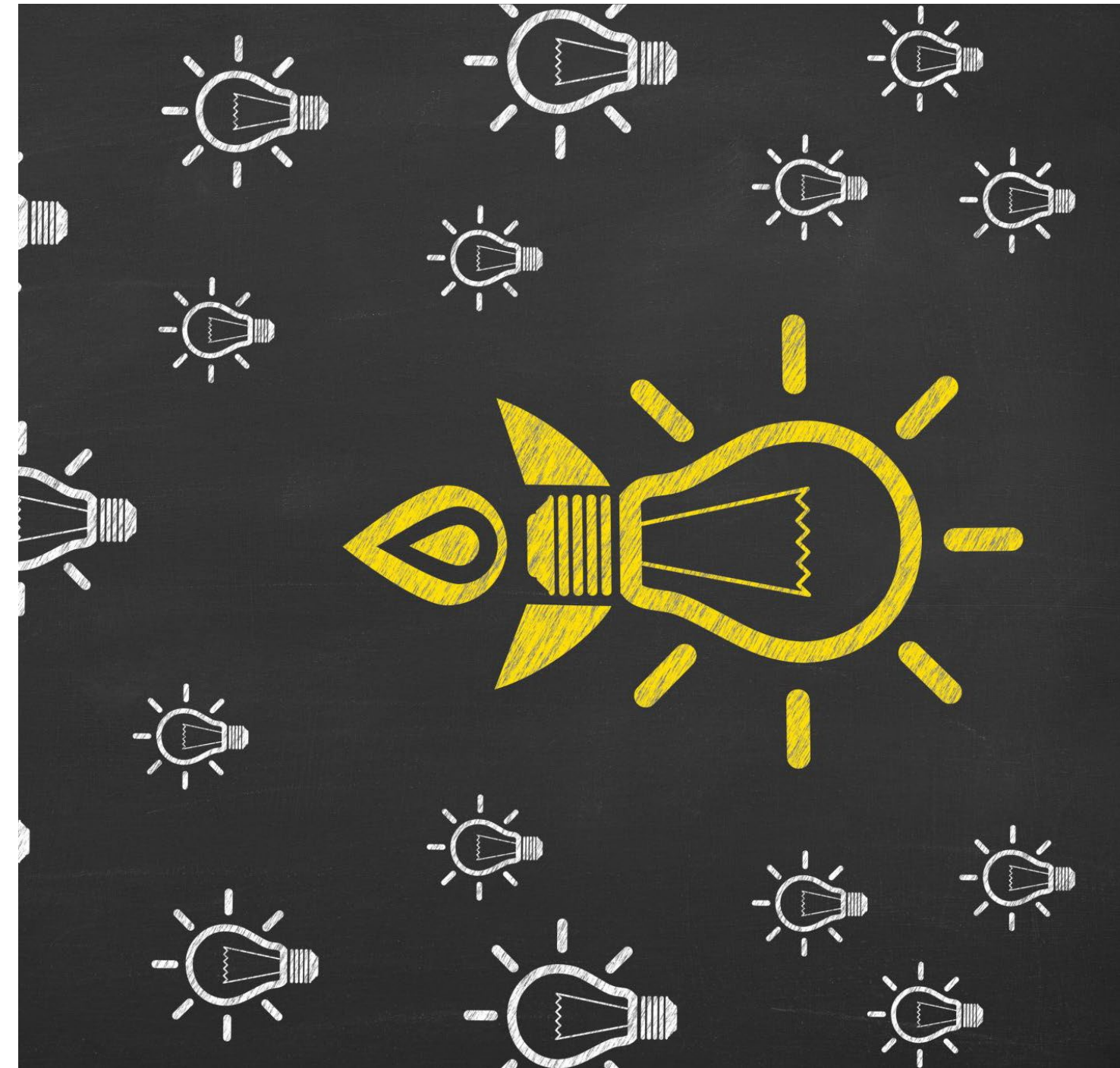


Solution Generation



Solution Generation

Class discussion: Once you have identified the problem to solve, what are some techniques for finding solutions?



How to Start **a Startup**

WELCOME, AND IDEAS, PRODUCTS, TEAMS AND EXECUTION **PART I**

SAM ALTMAN

President, Y Combinator

 @sama

sam@ycombinator.com

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CBYhVcO4Wgl>

Lean Canvas Recap



Intro to the Lean Canvas

The Lean Canvas visually presents the core assumptions for the main elements of a business:

- 1. Problem
- 2. Solution
- 3. Unique Value Proposition
- 4. Unfair Advantage
- 5. Customer Segments
- 6. Existing Alternatives
- 7. Key Metrics
- 8. High Level Concept
- 9. Channels
- 10. Early Adopters
- 11. Cost Structure
- 12. Revenue Structure
- 13. The Team
- 14. Financing

Lean Canvas		For:	By:	Version/Date:
Problem Top 3 problems	Solution Top 3 features	Unique Value Proposition Single, clear and compelling message that states why you are different and worth buying	Unfair Advantage Can't be easily copied or bought	Customer Segments Target Customers
Existing Alternatives List how these problems are solved today.	Key Metrics Key activities you measure	High-Level Concept List your X for Y analogy (e.g. YouTube = Flickr for videos)	Channels Path to customers	Early Adopters List the characteristics your ideal customers.
Cost Structure List your fixed and variable costs. Customer acquisition costs Distribution costs Hosting People			Revenue Structure List your sources of revenue. Revenue Model Life Time Value Revenue Gross Margin	
The Team List the team Roles Names Unique Skills			Financing Where will funding come from Initial Funding Seed Funding Series A Series B, C, D IPO	
Lean Canvas is adapted from The Business Model Canvas (www.businessmodelgeneration.com/canvas). Word implementation: Chronos Limited (https://neoschronos.com). License: CC BY-SA 3.0				

Lean Canvas - 1. Problem

If there's no problem — there's no business idea to solve it, simple as that.

Clearly describe the problem you are trying to solve.

One way: Toyota's Why X 5 Analysis



Lean Canvas - 1. Problem

Example Scoob-e, an e-bike renting app in Vienna. Start with Why?

1. It's hard to move around in Vienna. But if we continue using the 'Why?' technique we might get to the following problems:
2. There are traffic jams if you use a car. People don't want to stay in traffic jams.
3. It's not easy to park your car in the city center. Finding a parking spot is a nuisance.
4. Public transport picks you up at certain spots, at certain times. Who wants to wait?
5. Most cars aren't eco-friendly.

In the end, you'll get the core problems that your prospects face.



Lean Canvas - 2. Solution

Review the Problems box. What is your solution to the problem?

Need ideas/clarifications/refining?

- Share your Lean Canvas Problems and drafts with colleagues
- Interview your target audience and find out their take
- Research on Web



Lean Canvas - 3. Unique Value Proposition

Establish a clear understanding of who your product is for and why users should choose your company instead of your competitors.

The word 'unique' is here for a reason. Your value proposition needs to stand out. There are so many companies on the market, you either get noticed or go home. There are three components to your UVP:

1. Who is this product for?
2. What is the clear benefit?
3. Why should they choose you instead of the others?



Lean Canvas - 3. Unique Value Proposition

UBER

Ride

Drive

FIND A CITY

HELP

SIGN IN



Tap the app, get a ride

Uber is the smartest way to get around. One tap and a car comes directly to you. Your driver knows exactly where to go. And payment is completely cashless.

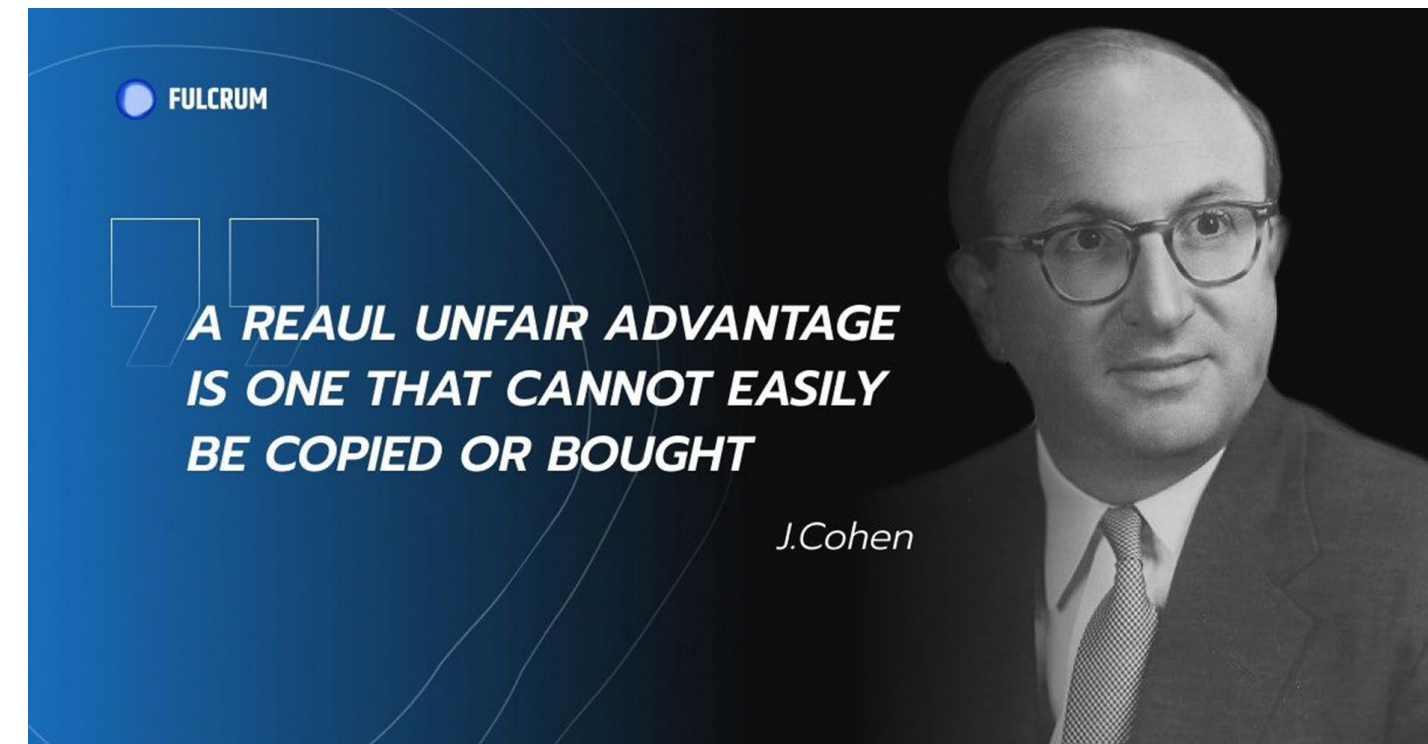
[MORE REASONS TO RIDE >](#)



Lean Canvas - 4. Unfair Advantage

What aspects of your solution, team, or approach give you an unfair advantage?

- Fantastic experts on your team?
- Cutting Edge Technologies?
- Access to a market?
- First-hand information about a disruption?
- New idea to improve on an existing one?



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